MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

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NCFE · LEVEL 1 · MATHEMATICS

NCFE Functional Skills Mathematics Level 1

September 2020 Section A · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 45 / 45 Marks (100%) Pass Mark Guide: ~60%

Specification / Paper Code: L1-Maths-Section-A-QP-NCFE

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

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HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	*Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)*
Centre Name:	*Master Functional Skills (MFS01)*
Lead Tutor:	*Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk*
Edition:	*2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)*

- Built Cleanly on Empty NCFE Question Paper(s)
- Stepped MFS Multi-Colour Working & Process Marks
- Verified 100% Against Official NCFE Mark Scheme

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Examiner use only

Activity 1: Coffee shop

1 (a) Harlow University has a coffee shop.

Students work in the coffee shop as volunteers.

Students can eat or drink in the coffee shop for free, but they are asked to leave a donation.

Q1(a) Worked Solution:

Since the start of term, students have left two thousand and twenty pounds in donations.

Write two thousand and twenty as a number.

[1 mark]

No and
and
seen
or 0.375 and 0.40 seen or
37.5% and 40%
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1
and
seen
or 0.375 and 0.40 seen or
[2 marks]

Your answer:

1 (b) The coffee shop has ten volunteer managers.

Six were also volunteer managers last year.

Write $\frac{6}{10}$ as a percentage.

[1 mark]

Q1(b) Worked Solution:

Yes and 1.9 (m) and 1 (m) seen
OR 190 (cm) and 100 (cm)
Award 4 marks if correct answer given
1
1.8 × 100 and 0.9 × 100
OE any correct pair of conversions
1
9.5 × 20 or 190 or 5 × 20 or 100
OE any correct use of scale
1
[4 marks]

Your answer: %

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

1 (c) 126 students who graduated last year volunteered in the coffee shop.

This is $\frac{1}{6}$ of the total number of students who graduated.

How many students graduated in total?

[2 marks]

Q1(c) Worked Solution:
UPS 2 (staff)
[1 mark]

Your answer: **students**

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

1 (d) Last year, there were 900 first year students.

25% of the first year students volunteered in the coffee shop.

Of these, $\frac{1}{5}$ volunteered regularly.

How many first year students volunteered regularly?

[3 marks]

Q1(d) Worked Solution:
UPS (£)98(.00)
[1 mark]

Your answer: **students**

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

1 (e) Jessica is one of the volunteers.

She bakes cupcakes, scones and biscuits for the coffee shop.

She needs:

- 670 g of flour for the cupcakes
- 480 g of flour for the scones
- 2 kg of flour for the biscuits.

How much flour does Jessica need in total?

Give your answer in kg

[2 marks]

Q1(e) Worked Solution:

(£)72(.00)

Award 4 marks if correct answer given

1

2 × 240 × 0.9 or 432

OE accept 240 × 0.9 or 216

S

Level 1 – P001371

1

450 – (450 ÷ 5) or 360

1

[4 marks]

Your answer: **kg**

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

1 (f) Jessica is baking a cake for the coffee shop.

She has a cake tin with a rectangular base, measuring 16.5 cm by 9 cm and a depth of 4 cm

Jessica needs to use a cake tin with a volume greater than 500 cm^3

Q1(f) Worked Solution:

See below

I

Appropriate titles

eg takings and frequency

H28a

I

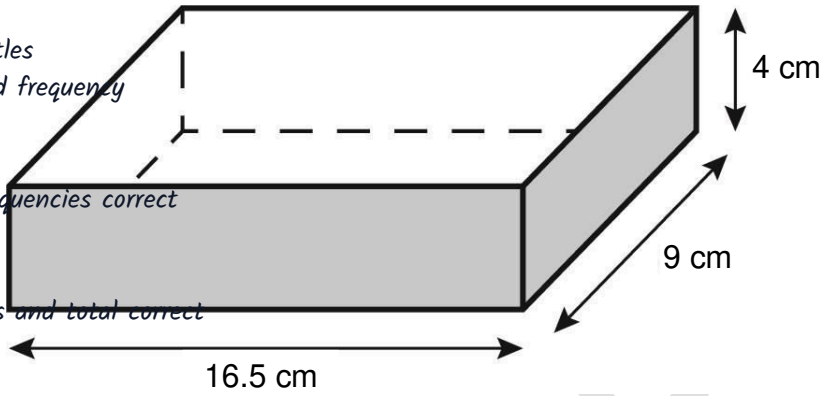
At least 3 frequencies correct

H28a

I

All frequencies and total correct

[3 marks]



Is her cake tin big enough?

Show how you decide.

[3 marks]

Your answer:	

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

1 (g) These are the weights of the cakes Jessica baked yesterday:

1.2 kg	1.1 kg	1.4 kg	1.6 kg	1.2 kg

She thinks the mean weight of the cakes is 1.4 kg

Is she correct?

Show how you decide.

[3 marks]

Q1(g) Worked Solution:

No and 1.3
Award 3 marks if correct answer given
1
6.5
1
(1.2 + 1.1 + 1.4 + 1.6 + 1.2) ÷ 5
OR
1.4 × 5 or 7
H29a
1
[3 marks]

Your answer:

[Total marks: 15]

This is the end of Section A.

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

Activity 2: Delivery driver

2 (a) Claire is a delivery driver.

She keeps a record of the times taken to make deliveries on Monday.

Delivery 1: 20 minutes
Delivery 2: 45 minutes
Delivery 3: 3 hours and 35 minutes
Delivery 4: 2 hours and 5 minutes

Q2(a) Worked Solution:

Claire says her deliveries took over $6\frac{1}{2}$ hours on Monday.

Is she correct?

Show how you decide.

[3 marks]

(£)9000
Award 3 marks if correct answer given
1
5 × 5 or 25
1
54000 or 6
54000 implies first mark
1
(£)9000
[3 marks]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

2 (b) Claire follows the same route every Tuesday.

Last Tuesday the route took Claire exactly 5 hours.

This Tuesday she completed the route in 20% less time.

How long did it take Claire to complete the route this Tuesday?

[2 marks]

Q2(b) Worked Solution:

UPS 7.2 (m3)
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1
(1.25 × 3.6 × 1.6)
or 7.2
1
7.2 (m3)
[2 marks]

Your answer: **hours**

2 (c) To estimate the area she covers, Claire does the calculation 3×45^2

What answer should she get?

[1 mark]

Q2(c) Worked Solution:

UPS (£)5500(.00)
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
6
Level 1 – P001371
1
5000 + (5000 × 0.05) × 2
or 5000 + 500
1
(£)5500(.00)
[2 marks]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

2 (d) Every Wednesday Claire delivers milk for a local farm.

She delivers 400 bottles of milk in total.

The ratio of bottles of semi skimmed to bottles of whole milk is 4 : 1

30% of the bottles for semi skimmed milk are plastic.

Q2(d) Worked Solution:

5% of the bottles for whole milk are plastic.

The rest of the milk bottles are glass.

Use this information to complete the table.

[5 marks]

16 (m2)
Award 4 marks if correct answer given
1
2 or 3 or 4 or 6
Accept any dimension rounded up
Can be seen on diagram
1
Any calculation of rectangular area e.g.
3.8 × 2.6 or 3 × 4 or 6 × 3
(6 × 3) – (1 × 2)
[4 marks]

	Plastic bottles	Glass bottles	Total
Semi skimmed milk			
Whole milk			
Total			

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

2 (e) Claire charges the farm a fee of £125 for delivering their milk plus 45p per mile.

Which calculation shows the total charge in pounds for a 62-mile trip?

Tick the correct calculation.

[1 mark]

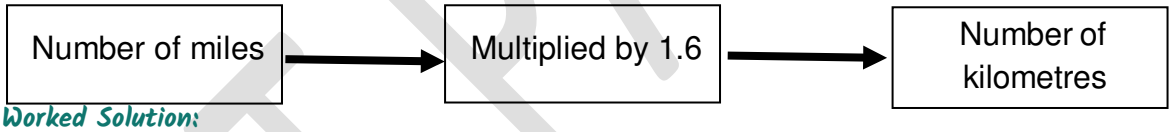
Q2(e) Worked Solution:

125 + 0.45 + 62	
125 × 0.45 × 62	
125 + 0.45 × 62	
125 × 0.45 + 62	

PS (£)425(.00)
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1

2 (f) On Thursday morning Claire drove 65 miles in total.

Claire finds this rule:



Q2(f) Worked Solution:

How many kilometres did she drive?

[1 mark]

PS Yes and 6.25 pm or 1.05 pm seen
OR Yes and 5hrs 25mins or 5hrs 30mins
OR Yes and 5.42hrs or 5.5hrs
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1
40 + 1hr 10mins + 2 hrs + 1hr 35mins or
5hrs 25mins
40 + 70 + 120 + 95 or 325 or 5hrs 25mins or
6.30 – 1 (hr) = 5.30
1
[2 marks]

Your answer: **km**

PAST PAPER

Question 2(e) · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

85×5 or

425

1

(£)425(.00)

[2 marks]

Examiner use only

2 (g) Claire drove 120 kilometres on Thursday afternoon.

What is 120 kilometres in metres?

[1 mark]

Q2(g) Worked Solution:
120 000 (m)
[1 mark]

Your answer: **m**

2 (h) On Friday Claire delivers parcels.

She weighs four of the parcels.

Weight (kilograms)			
3.505	3.05	3.5	3.055

Q2(h) Worked Solution:
3.05 3.055 3.5 3.505
Activity 3:

Put these weights in order starting with the smallest.

[1 mark]

Staycation
(Calculator Test)
Marks UPS
/ PS
(with guidance)
[1 mark]

_____ _____ _____ _____

[Total marks: 15]

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

Activity 3: Staycation

3 (a) Alex and his family decide to hire a motorhome for a holiday.

They find these two deals:

Company A	Company B
£775 per week	£825 per week
10% off	5% off

Q3(a) Worked Solution:

(£)245

Award 3 marks if correct answer given

1 Which company is giving more money off?

700 × or 280

1 Show how you decide.

700 × 0.25 or 175

1

(£)245

[3 marks]

[2 marks]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

3 (b) Alex then finds these two last-minute deals:

Company C	**Company D**
Motorhome Hire	Motorhome Hire
Next Week	Next Week
35% off	$\frac{2}{5}$ off

Q3(b) Worked Solution:

See below

1

Both companies charge the same amount before the offer.

Which company has the better discount?

Show how you decide.

[2 marks]

Linear scale starting at zero
H27d
1
Suitable y axis label
H27d
1
4 points plotted correctly
Any 4 points (scale must be linear within
[4 marks]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

3 (c) Alex's daughter Amber has been saving pennies for her holiday spending money.



She has saved 14 774p

What is the value of 14 774p in pounds?

[1 mark]

Q3(c) Worked Solution:
UPS 18 (°C)
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1
(15 + 17 + 17 + 16 + 16 + 22 + 23) ÷ 7 or
18
H29a
1
18 (°C)
H29a
[2 marks]

Your answer: £

3 (d) Alex drives the motorhome onto a campsite.

He drives in facing south and turns to face north west.

What is the size of the angle Alex has turned through?

[1 mark]

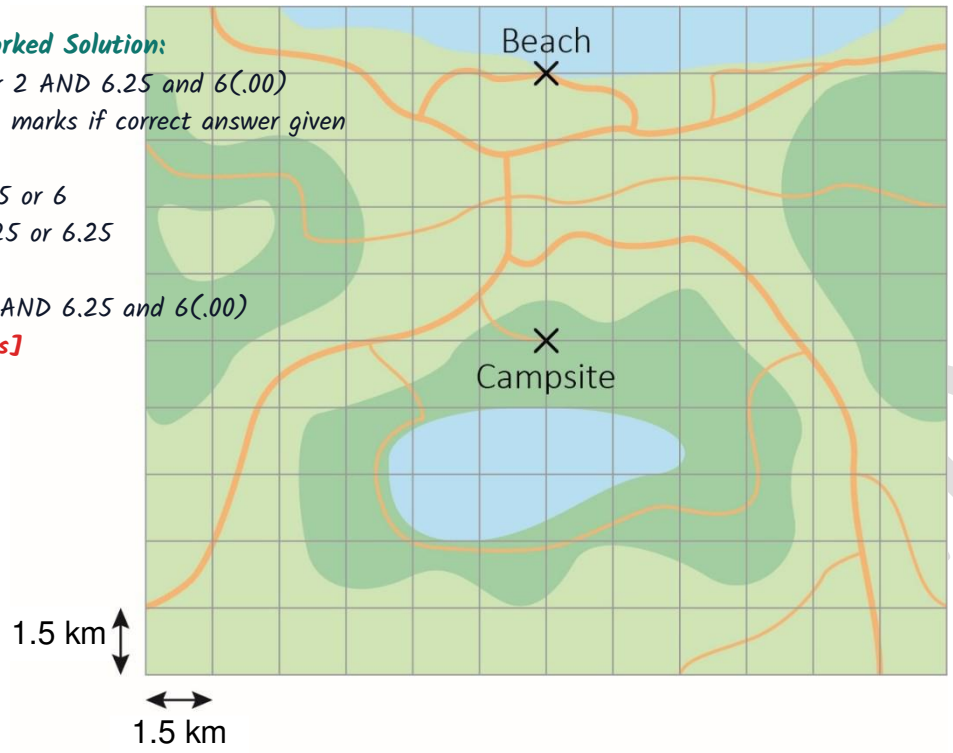
Q3(d) Worked Solution:
PS 4.6 (kg)
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1
18.4 (kg)
1
4.6 (kg)
[2 marks]

Your answer: °

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

3 (e) This map shows the position of the campsite and the beach.



Q3(e) Worked Solution:

PS Offer 2 AND 6.25 and 6(.00)
Award 2 marks if correct answer given
1
40 × 0.15 or 6
25 × 0.25 or 6.25
1
Offer 2 AND 6.25 and 6(.00)
[2 marks]

How far is it from the campsite to the beach?

[2 marks]

Your answer: **km**

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

3 (f) Alex looks at the temperatures forecast for the next 5 days at the beach.

Day	Temperature (°C)
Monday	23
Tuesday	28
Wednesday	24
Thursday	15
Friday	18

Q3(f) Worked Solution:

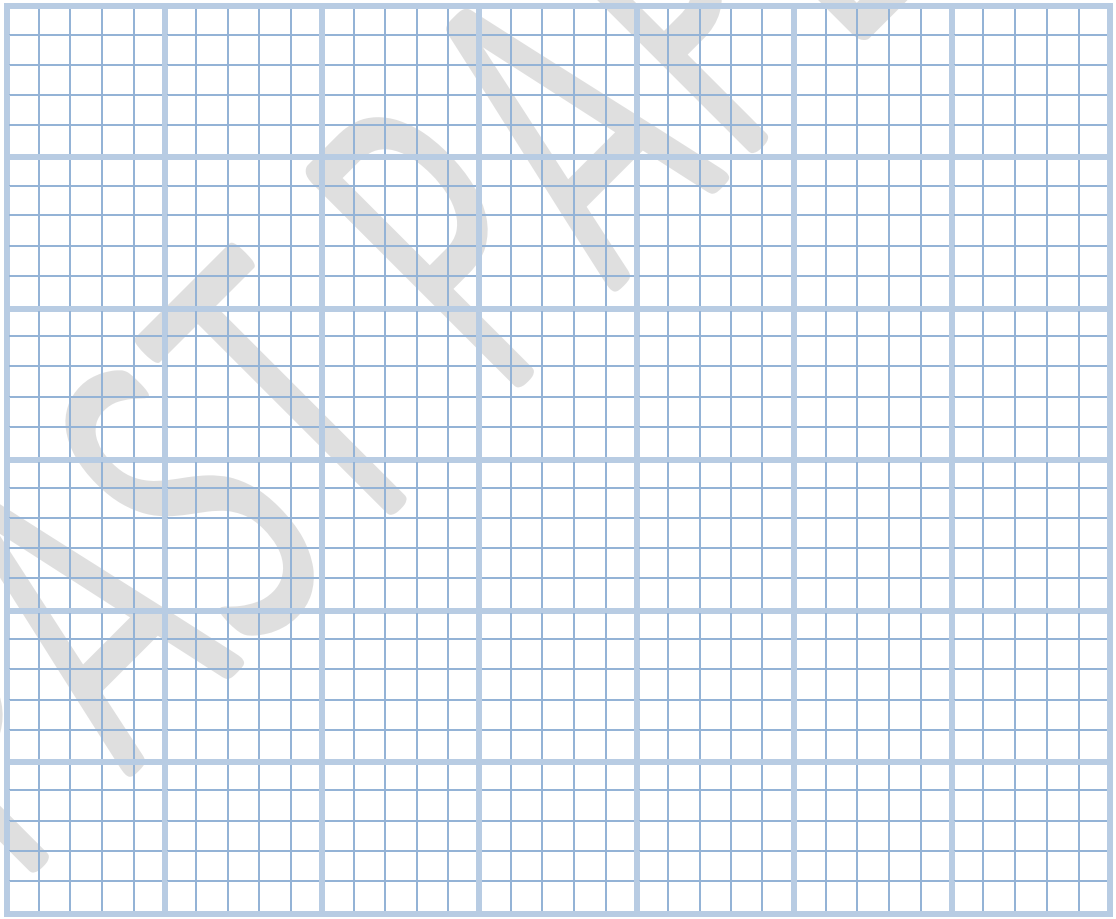
Use this information to create a line graph.

[4 marks]

UPS Acute

[1 mark]

Temperature at the beach



PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

3 (g) The family sits at an octagonal table for lunch.

Draw an octagon.

[1 mark]

Q3(g) Worked Solution:
UPS 18.17
8
Level 1 – P001371
Activity 4:
Climate change
(Calculator)
/ PS
(with guidance)
[1 mark]

3 (h) The family keep a record of how many miles they drive each day.

The numbers have been rounded to the nearest mile.

85	10	22	45	72	56	51
4	42	45	59	26	38	18
21	5	25	41	32	28	75

Q3(h) Worked Solution:
Use the data to complete the grouped frequency table below.

[2 marks]

Number of Miles
Number of Days
0 - 19
4
20 - 39
7
40 - 59
7
60 +
3
[2 marks]

Number of Miles	Number of Days
0 - 19	
20 - 39	
40 - 59	
60 +	
Total	

[Total marks: 15]

Please turn over

Examiner use only

Activity 4: Using the internet

4 (a) Rana uses a comparison website to get a quote for her electricity bill.

She finds these six quotes.

£490	£508	£522	£483	£474	£496

Q4(a) Worked Solution:

Calculate the range of these quotes.

[1 mark]

UPS One thousand one hundred and fifty-four
Accept incorrect spelling as long as the intention is clear
[1 mark]

Your answer: **£**

4 (b) Rana uses online banking to apply for a loan.

She takes out a loan for £1725 over 3 years.

The interest rate is 5% simple interest per year.

How much will Rana pay back in total?

Q4(b) Worked Solution:

[2 marks]

UPS 219000 (square miles)
[1 mark]

Your answer: **£**

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

4 (c) Rana does some online shopping.

She needs to buy a lunch box and finds this information:

Colour	Red	Green	Yellow	Blue
Number in stock	8	2	6	4

Q4(c) Worked Solution:

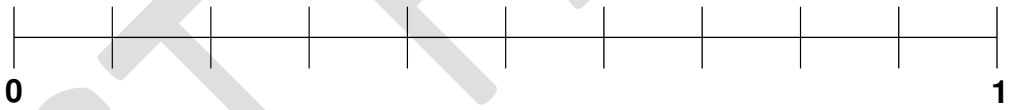
The company selects a lunch box at random from those in stock.

What is the probability that the company selects a green lunch box?

Mark your answer on the probability scale below.

[2 marks]

PS -16.2(°C) or -16(°C)
Award 3 marks if correct answer given
1
5
1
((-4 + 9) - 32) × 0.6
or -27 × 0.6 or -16.2
or -16
1
-16.2(°C) Or -16(°C)
[3 marks]



PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

4 (d) Rana wants to buy a dress online.

The dress comes in these four different lengths.

Dress	Short	Mid	Long	Maxi
Length	76 cm	94 cm	102 cm	147 cm

Q4(d) Worked Solution:

Rana wants the dress with length closest to 40 inches.

She knows that to convert inches into cm she needs to multiply the inches by 2.54

Which length dress does Rana buy?

PS 1995

Show how you decide.

[2 marks]

CAO Do not accept 0.97

[1 mark]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

4 (e) Rana sets up a monthly delivery for some everyday items.

If she arranges for the same five items to be delivered every month, she will receive a 15% discount.

The original total cost of the items is £87

Q4(e) Worked Solution:

What is the total cost of the items after the discount?

[2 marks]

PS See below
I
Axis labels
H27c
I
A linear scale
Accept if does not start at zero
H27c
I
At least 3 bars correctly plotted
[4 marks]

Your answer: £

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

4 (f) Rana uses her online banking app to check her spending.

Category	Amount spent to the nearest pound
Rent	800
Utilities	360
Entertainment	100
Shopping	180
Total	**1440**

Q4(f) Worked Solution:

UPS 1.3

H29b Draw a pie chart to represent the amount Rana spent on each category.

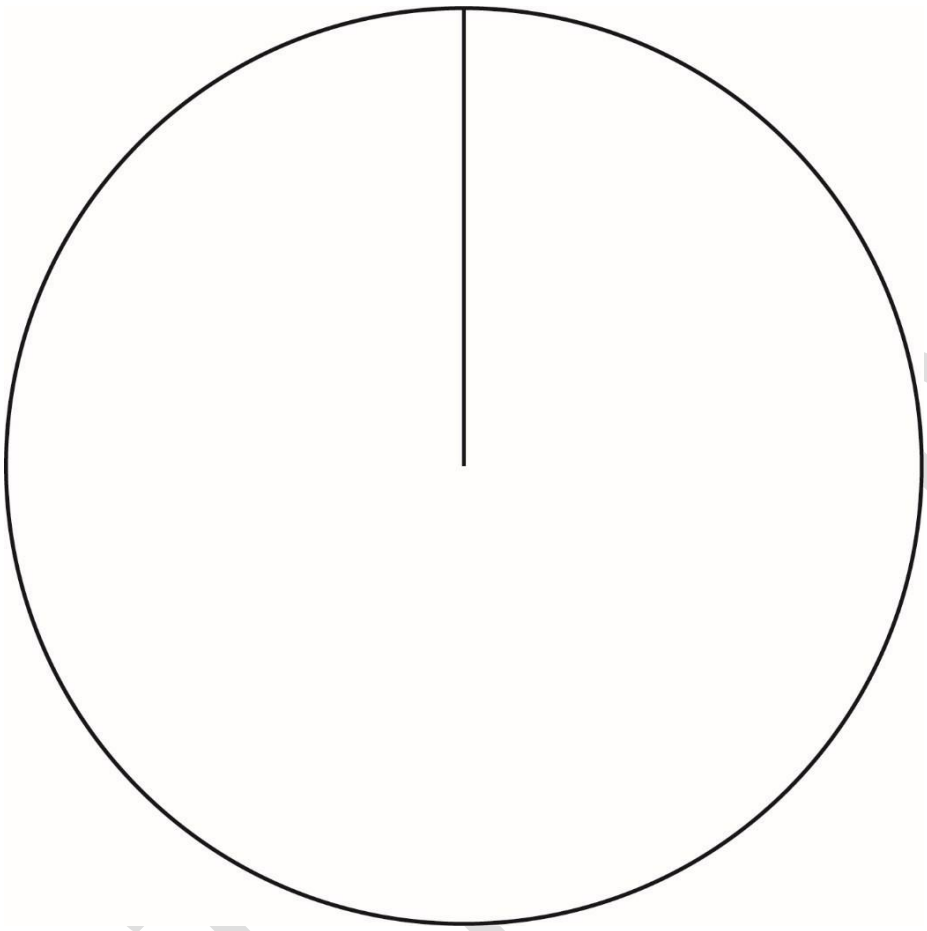
[1 mark]

[4 marks]

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Examiner use only

Amount spent on each category



PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

4 (g) Rana checks her bank balance.
It is £46.15

She knows there is a direct debit for £50 due to come out of her account.

What is £46.15 – £50?

[1 mark]

Q4(g) Worked Solution:
UPS (Town) C
Accept
H30b
[1 mark]

Your answer: £

4 (h) In May 2020, online sales in the UK increased by 130%

130% is the same as one and three tenths.

Write one and three tenths using numbers.

[1 mark]

Q4(h) Worked Solution:
H30a
[1 mark]

Your answer:

[Total marks: 15]

This is the end of the assessment.

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

Activity 1: Boarding kennels

1 (a) Boarding kennels look after cats and dogs.

Linda is setting up a boarding kennel business.

She researches other kennels and finds that:

- $\frac{3}{8}$ of kennels take dogs only
- $\frac{2}{5}$ of kennels take cats only.

Linda thinks that more kennels take dogs only than take cats only.

Is she correct?

Show how you decide.

[2 marks]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

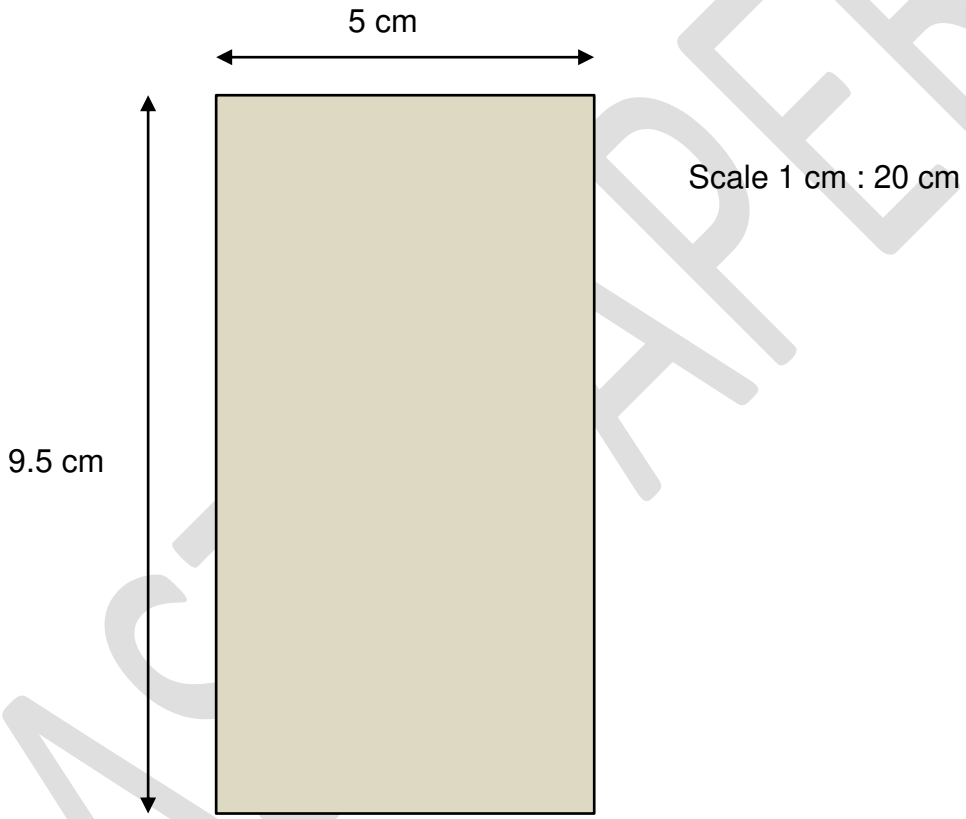
Examiner use only

1 (b) Boarding kennels have enclosures where the animals sleep.



Each enclosure must be a minimum of 1.8 m high and 0.9 m wide.

This is a scale diagram showing the front view of an enclosure Linda wants to install.



PAPER

Examiner use only

Is this enclosure big enough?

Show how you decide.

[4 marks]

Your answer:

PAST PAPER

Please turn over

Examiner use only

1 (c) Linda knows the ratio of staff to dogs needs to be 1 : 15

How many staff will she need for 30 dogs?

[1 mark]

Your answer:

1 (d) Linda places an online advert for her business.

She pays £0.98 each time someone clicks on her advert.

How much will it cost her if 100 people click on her advert?

[1 mark]

Your answer: **£**

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

1 (e) Linda looks at the cost of placing 6 half-page adverts in a local newspaper:

	Cost	
Advert size	**3 Adverts**	**6 Adverts**
Full Page	£330	£600
Half Page	£240	£450
Quarter Page	£150	£270

Linda sees these offers:

- **Offer A:** place 3 adverts and get 10% off the cost.
- **Offer B:** place 6 adverts and get $\frac{1}{5}$ off the cost.

She chooses **Offer B**.

How much will she save by choosing **Offer B** instead of **Offer A**?

[4 marks]

Your answer: **£**

Please turn over

PAST PAPER

Examiner use only

1 (f) Linda also sells pet food.

The table shows Linda's takings in the first week:

£10.50	£5	£6.30	£7.20	£15	£8	£14.20	£6.50	£8
£5.67	£10.60	£13	£14.50	£15.78	£7.50	£3.40	£5.60	£4.55

Complete the frequency table for this data.

[3 marks]

£0 – £4.99	
£5 – £9.99	
£10 – £14.99	
£15+	
Total:	

[Total marks: 15]

This is the end of Section A.

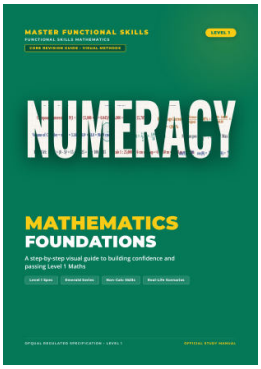
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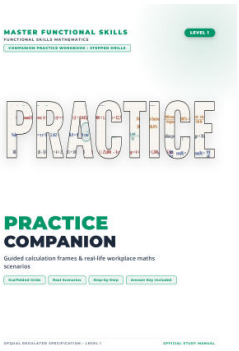


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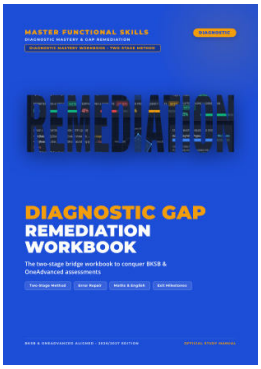


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